



An unchecked AI infrastructure boom could create a paradox where the technology meant to optimise human systems ends up stressing the resources people depend upon

SUSTAINABILITY • DATA CENTRES

DELIVERING CLEAN AI

AI DATA CENTRES ARE POWER AND WATER-HUNGRY, WITH LARGE CENTRES CONSUMING CITY-SCALE RESOURCES. CAN SUSTAINABLE DATA CENTRES POWER AN AI-LED FUTURE?

BY SHELLEY SINGH



ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) workloads are rising globally. Futuristic ideas like orbital data centres are

being explored to reduce pressure on land, water, and power resources. But on earth, and especially in India, the immediate challenge is how to build AI infrastructure sustainably.

AI data centres or AI's factories, packed with power and water-guzzling chips, are coming up across cities and industrial corridors to fuel modern life. Global technology companies, including Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft and Google, are collectively pouring in more than \$60 billion into India's AI and cloud infrastructure ecosystem.

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